



Figure 5: Haiku

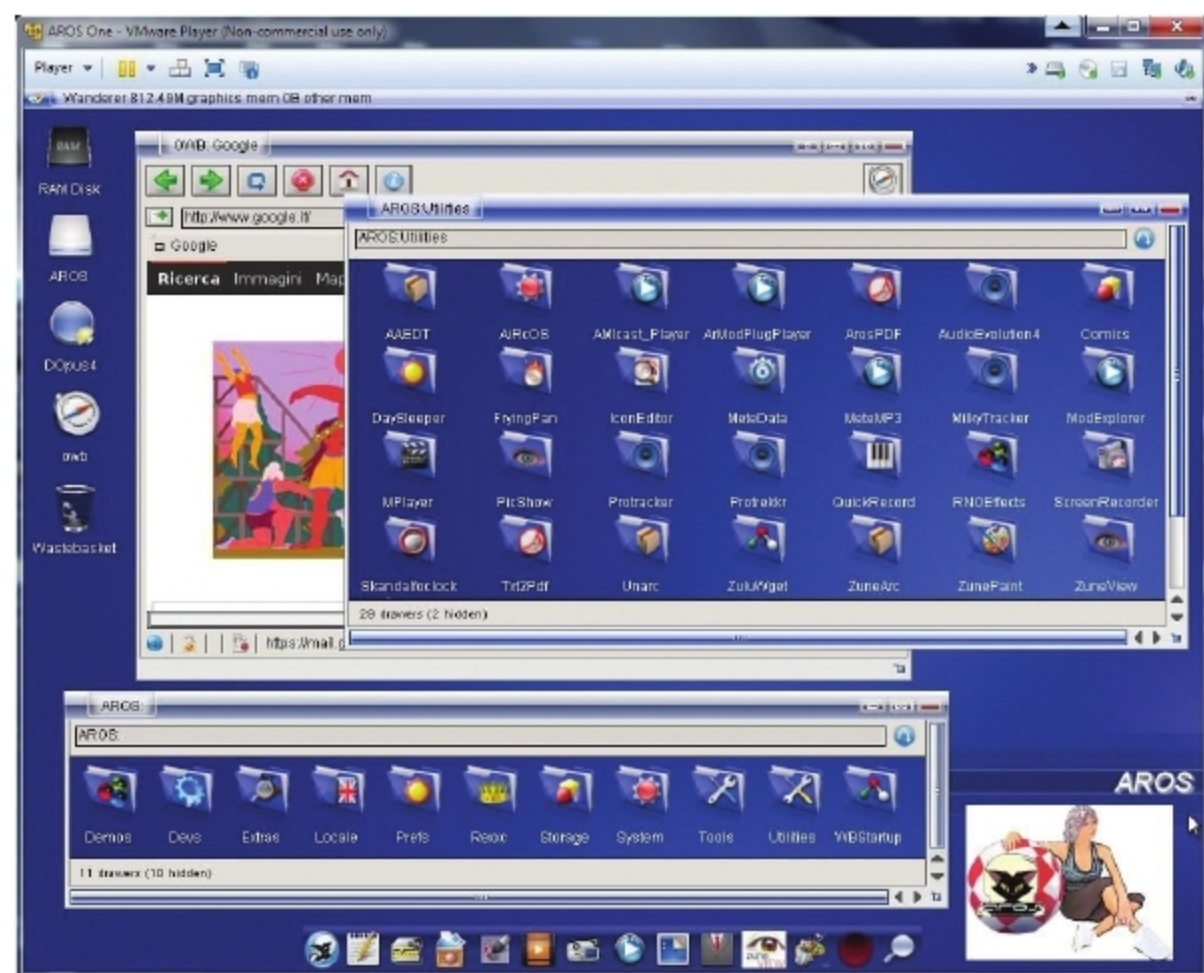


Figure 6: AROS



Figure 7: Chrome OS

Thunderbird, the Budgie desktop environment, PlayOnLinux, Firefox and OpenShot Video Editor. Solus 3, the latest version, was released in August 2017 and is thought to have some twists in its Opus encoder and multimedia filters.

5. Haiku

Haiku is free and open source. It was initially released in 2001. This free operating system has been in normal development and runs numerous apps, some of which you will have heard about, such as VLC Media Player and Quake. Haiku runs many apps from the BeOS operating system.

However, Haiku releases are rare, making it perhaps the least exciting option on this list. Nevertheless, if you're considering a free replacement for Windows, it's absolutely worth looking at it.

6. AROS

This free operating system has a heritage comparable to MorphOS but was planned for x86 systems. This means that it should be capable of running on your PC. In some respects, your PC or laptop will then change into a modern-day Amiga computer, able to run old and new software.

However, you'll be unable to read old Amiga discs on a modern PC, even with an 8.9cm (3.5-inch) drive. As such, you'll be limited to ROMs. Even so, this makes for an exciting alternative to Windows. There's a live CD available with which you can try out AROS.

7. Chrome OS

Chrome OS is a partially open source operating system that includes many alluring features. It is also a part of the Chromium and Linux families. It includes features such as raised security, support for elected Android apps, Chrome apps, Aura windows manager, virtual desktop access, integrated media player, Google cloud print and cloud based management, and many more.

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